

Numbers and Sets

ECON 441: Introduction to Mathematical Economics
Lecture 1

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Introductions

- Your preferred name and pronouns
- Why are you here?
 - Undergrads: why you signed up for this class
 - Grad students: why you're doing the MA
- The last math class you took, and roughly when
- Your comfort food

Real-Number System

- **Integers:**

$\dots, -3, -2, -1, 0, 1, 2, 3, \dots$

- **Fractions:**

$$\frac{1}{2}, \frac{3}{5}, -\frac{2}{3}$$

- **Rational numbers:** ratio of integers
- **Are fractions rational numbers? What about integers?**

Real-Number System

- **Rational numbers:** ratio of integers
 - “terminating or repeating decimal”
 - Example. $\frac{1}{3} = 0.333$, $\frac{1}{4} = 0.25$
- **Irrational numbers:** cannot be expressed as a ratio of two integers
 - “nonterminating or nonrepeating decimal”
 - Example. $\sqrt{2} = 1.4142$, $\pi = 3.1415$
- **Real numbers ($\mathbb{R}$):** rational and irrational

Sets

- A **set** is a collection of distinct objects.

$$A = \{brownies, icecream, pizza, ramen\}$$

- $pizza \in A$, $\in$ stands for 'is in'
- Other ways of writing a set

$$B = \{x | x \text{ is a positive integer}\}$$

$$C = \{x | 1 < x < 5\}$$

Set Relations

- Equivalence ($=$)

$$A = \{brownies, icecream, pizza, ramen\}$$

$$B = \{pizza, ramen, icecream, brownies\}$$

$$A = B$$

- Subset ($\subset$)

$$C = \{pizza, ramen\}$$

$C \neq A$ but $C \subset A$. Note: $A \supset C$ is equivalent.

Is $A \subset B$?

Set Relations

- Disjoint sets

$$A = \{brownies, icecream, pizza, ramen\}$$

$$D = \{salad, fruits\}$$

- Neither but still related

$$A = \{brownies, icecream, pizza, ramen\}$$

$$E = \{salad, fruits, icecream\}$$

Set Relations

- $\emptyset$: empty or null set
- What are all possible subsets of $S = \{a, b, c\}$?

$\emptyset, \{a\}, \{b\}, \{c\}, \{a, b\}, \{b, c\}, \{a, c\}, \{a, b, c\}$

Always 2^n subsets. Here $n = 3$, so 8 subsets.

Set Operations

- **Union:** $A \cup B$, elements in either A **or** B
- **Intersection:** $A \cap B$, elements in both A **and** B

Example:

$$A = \{brownies, icecream, pizza, ramen\}$$

$$B = \{salad, fruits, icecream\}$$

$$A \cup B =$$

$$A \cap B =$$

Set Operations

- **Union:** $A \cup B$, elements in either A or B
- **Intersection:** $A \cap B$, elements in both A and B

What about

$$A = \{brownies, icecream, pizza, ramen\}$$

$$B = \{salad, fruits\}$$

$$A \cup B =$$

$$A \cap B =$$

Set Operations

- **Complement of A :** $\tilde{A}$ or A^c , 'not A '
- Universal set U (context specific) then:

$$A^c = \{x | x \in U \text{ and } x \notin A\}$$

Example. $U = \{1, e, f, 2\}$, $A = \{1, 2\}$, then $A^c = \{e, f\}$.

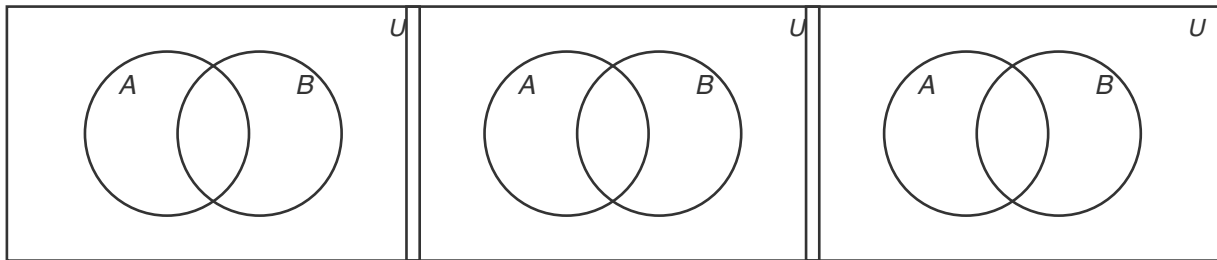
Set Operations: Venn Diagrams

Shade the following regions:

$A \cup B$

$A \cap B$

A^c



Laws of Set Operations

- Commutative law

$$A \cup B = B \cup A \quad A \cap B = B \cap A$$

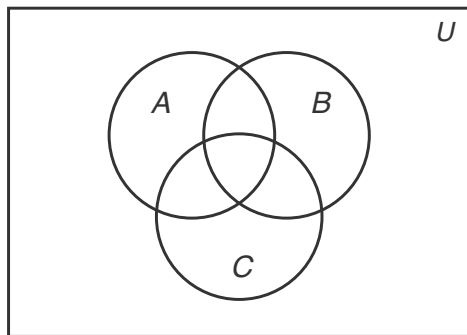
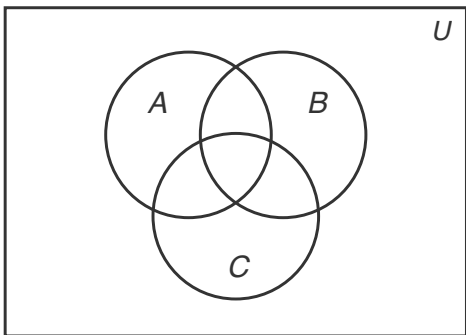
- Distributive law

$$A \cup (B \cap C) = (A \cup B) \cap (A \cup C)$$

$$A \cap (B \cup C) = (A \cap B) \cup (A \cap C)$$

Distributive law

Verify by shading: $A \cup (B \cap C) = (A \cup B) \cap (A \cup C)$

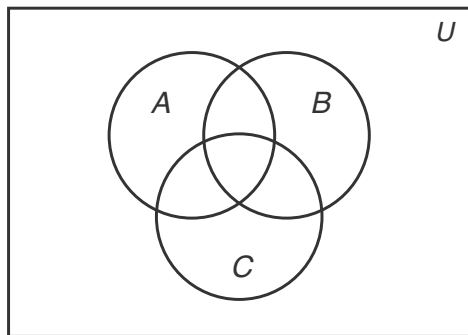
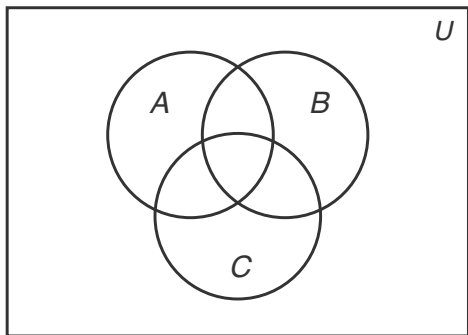


Distributive law

Now the right-hand side, $(A \cup B) \cap (A \cup C)$:

$A \cup B$

$A \cup C$



Ordered Sets

- We said order does not matter for sets
- But we can have ordered sets where

$$(a, b) \neq (b, a) \text{ unless } a = b$$

- Ordered pairs, triples,...

Example. $(age, weight)$, $(22, 120)$ different from $(120, 22)$

Cartesian Product

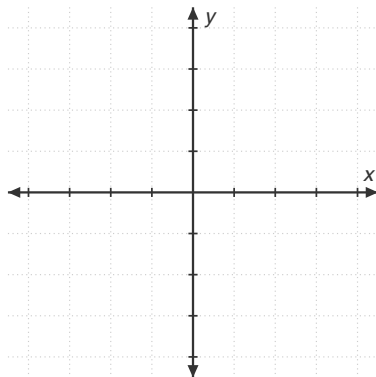
$$A = \{1, 2\} \quad B = \{3, 4\}$$

Cartesian Product: set of all possible ordered pairs

$$A \times B = \{(1, 3), (1, 4), (2, 3), (2, 4)\}$$

Cartesian Plane

$$\mathbb{R}^2 = \{(x, y) | x \in \mathbb{R}, y \in \mathbb{R}\}$$



Can have $\mathbb{R}^3, \mathbb{R}^4, \dots, \mathbb{R}^n$

By the way

What is $x \times x$?

What is $x^2 \times x$?

What is $x^2 \times x^2$?

More generally, $x^n \times x^m = x^{m+n}$